

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



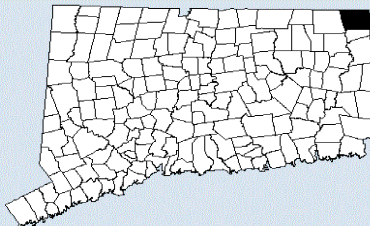
Thompson School District

Ms. Melinda Smith, Superintendent • 860-923-9581 • <http://www.district.thompsonk12.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	3
Enrollment	976
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,811
Total Expenditures ¹	\$20,564,068

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	452	46.3	48.4
Male	524	53.7	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	7	0.7	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	72	7.4	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	32	3.3	4.0
White	857	87.8	49.9
English Learners	*	*	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	467	47.8	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	195	20.0	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	122	27.9	11	2.3
Male	147	30.2	26	4.7
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	38	52.1	6	7.6
White	213	26.5	27	3.0
English Learners	0	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	161	40.0	27	5.4
Students with Disabilities	67	37.4	12	5.5
District	269	29.1	37	3.6
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 159

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	71.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	22.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	12.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	12.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	3.0
School Level	4.6
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	6.0
School Nurses	4.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	58.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	100	100.0	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	8.4	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	*	*
White	45	83.3	45	95.7
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	20	87.0	16	*
Students with Disabilities	6	*	6	*
District	48	81.4	49	94.2
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	10	*
Emotional Disturbance	6	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	42	87.5
Other Health Impairment	18	72.0
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	37	100.0
District	121	71.6
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	19	2.0	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	19	2.0	1.1
Intellectual Disability	11	1.1	0.5
Learning Disability	48	4.9	5.8
Other Health Impairment	25	2.6	3.3
Other Disabilities	13	1.3	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	46	4.7	1.9
All Disabilities	181	18.6	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$10,232,235	\$9,858	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$1,431,251	\$1,469	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$702,178	\$721	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$538,443	\$553	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$2,553,290	\$2,621	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$1,688,640	\$1,734	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$1,906,214	\$1,957	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$1,509,073	\$1,472	\$1,159
Food services	\$2,743	\$3	\$21
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$151
Total	\$20,564,068	\$19,811	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$1,595,720	29.8	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$535,468	10.0	11.1
Other Salaries	\$262,557	4.9	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$566,579	10.6	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$168,094	3.1	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,628,609	30.4	22.5
Supplies	\$26,774	0.5	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$569,345	10.6	7.2
Equipment	\$9,300	0.2	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$175	0.0	0.1
Total	\$5,362,622	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		26.1	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	57.6
State	39.2
Federal	3.0
Tuition & Other	0.3

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	24	75.0
Students with Disabilities	6	*
District	48	85.4
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	80.0	15	25.0
Male	78.4	11	21.6
Black or African American	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	0	*
White	78.2	26	25.7
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	79.5	7	17.9
Students with Disabilities	*	0	*
District	79.3	26	23.4
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	*	92.3
Male	63.0	*
Black or African American	N/A	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	75.0	89.5
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	65.0	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	70.5	88.4
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	29.1%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	38.1%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	87.4%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	23.4%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		75.3%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		85.4%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		75.7%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		70.4%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		61.6%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	90.9%	75.7%	15.2%	9.8%	Y

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

MRFES is committed to communicating regularly with families. We offer an annual Title I meeting open to parents and are forming a Title I parent advisory council. MRFES adopted Wonders as a core reading program and we use the Bridges program for Math. Tools of the Mind, Purposeful Play and the RULER program offer opportunities in social emotional learning. In science, we employed Eastbay Collaborative to provide PD and Foss kits. The School Improvement Team proposes Plan with goals and objectives that in turn support the district Strategic Plan. Our early childhood program continues to be NAEYC accredited. Parents connect through events: The Early Childhood Fair, PTO meetings, daily parent volunteers, Open House, Math Night and parent conferences, PAWS for Reading, the summer Governor's Reading Challenge, Bedtime Stories and Read Across America. MRFES offers technology devices for all students to increase engagement and opportunity. Interactive whiteboards are in all grades K-4. PD was designed in conjunction with the book Leaders of Their Own Learning: Transforming Schools Through Student Engagement and That One Kid. At TMS, grades 5 and 6 continue to implement the Wonders Reading Program as a core reading program. The Wonders Program provides high quality texts and aligns with our Connecticut Common State Standards for reading, writing, speaking, and listening. In grades 7 and 8, ELA teachers continue to promote lessons that support social/emotional literacy. They have also implemented a new incentive-based summer reading program that aligns with the Governor's Summer Reading Challenge. Grade 5-8 math teachers continue to utilize the strategies from a mathematics consultant. Science teachers have employed S.T.E.M. projects to engage students in higher order thinking skills. The district curriculum development leaders have also been working with teachers to develop and analyze learning targets and common summative assessments. In science, grades 5-8 continue to utilize FOSS kits from Eastbay Collaborative which align with the NGSS curriculum employing a true 3D Science teaching model. We employ push-in and pull-out models of instruction at all grade levels. Additionally, this year we have a Life Skills Program and a Therapeutic classroom for behaviorally challenged students. Thompson Public Schools has also partnered with TEEG to develop an outreach program for students and families with chronic absenteeism, truancy and student engagement. Parents and Community connect with our school in a variety of ways including volunteering at school events and field trips. Tourtellotte Memorial High School's Data Team reviews data including Next Generation Accountability, academic, climate, discipline, attendance, and accessibility. Factors that significantly impact the success of our school are our student leadership team, digital portfolios, senior tours, universal assessments, and online learning opportunities. Parents are engaged through School Governance Council and encouraged to attend Open House/Expo Night, Parent Teacher Conferences, Child Study Teams, and PPTs. Communication district-wide with parents includes, Tyler Portal, School Messenger, text, email, web and Facebook, Twitter, quarterly email communications and performance letters from administration, as well as monthly newsletters from each department.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

MRFES has established a partnership with TEEG (social service agency) to connect with families by making home visits for students not attending school. At school events we invite community members to set up information tables that include: TEEG, Hale YMCA, Boy Scouts, Girl Scouts, PTO, Thompson Library, Thompson Recreation, Dental van and the Northeast Early Childhood Collaborative. Mystic Aquarium has presented to students on marine biology and on-site historical programs have taken place at Roseland Cottage. Our students took part in Veteran's Day and Memorial Day assemblies. Opportunities in the summer include ESY and well as Jump Start. Free summer camp was offered for 4 hours per day. MRFES students each have a Chromebook or device to access education anywhere and anytime. Hot spots are provided to those families with no internet access. TMS provides educational opportunities for all students while promoting mutual respect and appreciation among all people. School activities and curriculum are developed to be respectful and inclusive of differences in our students' ethnicity, economic status, gender, and lifestyle. We have implemented a school wide PBIS initiative which includes a leadership committee composed of teachers and staff who plan and oversee events such as School Spirit Rallies, Fabulous Friday's, Field Day, and Students of the Month. Our positive Behavior Intervention System has been successful in the message of our Tiger Code: Be Respectful, Be Responsible, and Be Safe. Teams meet monthly providing behavior & academic data regarding struggling students. Tourtellotte Memorial High School offers a wide range of extracurricular activities. The Diversity Club continues to expand through affiliations with neighboring schools, ECC Nation, and UConn's True Colors event. Tourtellotte's Student Leadership Team meets monthly to discuss student concerns and affect positive change. In addition to all the intradistrict activities promoted by the TSLT, our student leaders continue to participate in the interdistrict Eastern Connecticut Student Leader Summit, networking with other area schools.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Thompson Board of Education's budgetary process has each cost center discussed in cooperation with the Board of Finance. This process makes the community aware of each of the cost centers, and provides a forum to review budget increases and additional programming. The Thompson Board of Education and Administration work very diligently to decrease operating costs and present the town with a budget that meets the needs of each individual school and program. All schools receive an equitable fixed amount based upon enrollments and prioritized needs. Some needs, such as Early Intervention in Literacy and Numeracy, as well as continued SRBI interventions implemented throughout the district, continue to be a district priority. Resources are also shared among the schools to decrease overhead costs while delivering critical programming. The collaboration between special services and each school to pool resources is a common practice to impact more students. The Title I grant and School Readiness provide additional resources as well as the elementary PTO, local grant opportunities, and local company donations.